

RANSOM

Short Film Script

FADE IN:

1. EXT. STREET – DAY

K1 (30s, wiry, restless) straddles his parked motorbike, thumb scrolling his phone. A loan app notification blinks red: EMI OVERDUE — FINAL NOTICE.

K1

(muttering to himself)

Third notice this month. Where am I supposed to find that kind of money.

He pockets the phone and looks up. Across the street, SON (8), backpack slung over one shoulder, walks alone, absorbed in his own phone.

K1's eyes track him. His expression shifts — worry hardening into calculation.

K1 (CONT'D)

(quieter, to himself)

One call. That's all it'd take.

He kills the engine, crosses the street, and falls into step behind SON, closing the gap without a sound.

In one motion, K1 yanks a cloth bag over SON's head and clamps down. SON thrashes, muffled — then goes limp. His phone skitters across the pavement. K1 snatches it up, pockets it, and hauls SON over his shoulder.

2. EXT./INT. SAFEHOUSE – DAY

A rundown shed sits alone off a dirt track, hemmed in by scrub. K1 arrives on foot, SON slung over his shoulder. He shoulders the door open.

INT. SAFEHOUSE – CONTINUOUS

Bare walls, a single shuttered window. K1 lowers SON to the floor against the wall and checks that he's still breathing.

He looks down at SON for a beat — the first flicker of doubt crossing his face — then turns and leaves, bolting the door from outside.

3. INT. K2'S HOUSE – DAY

A cramped, cluttered room. K2 and K3 look up as K1 lets himself in, agitated, still catching his breath.

K1

I did it. The boy — I've got him.

K2 rises, knocking his chair back.

K2

Are you out of your mind? You kidnapped a kid?

K3

(hand raised, steadying)

Hey. Hey — sit down. Both of you.

K2 paces, dragging a hand through his hair. K3 steps between them, lowering his voice.

K3 (CONT'D)

Shouting about it won't undo it. He's already taken. So what happens now is what matters.

K2 stops pacing. A long beat. He exhales, some of the fight going out of him.

K2

(quiet, resigned)

What's done is done.

K1 nods, relief and guilt fighting for space on his face. The three of them stand in uneasy agreement — in it together now, whether they meant to be or not.

4. INTERCUT – SAFEHOUSE / FATHER'S HOUSE

K1 dials from SON's phone. It rings once on the other end.

INT. FATHER'S HOUSE – CONTINUOUS

FATHER (40s) sees his son's name on the screen and answers instantly, relieved — then his face changes as a stranger's voice comes through.

FATHER

Who is this? Where's my son?

K1

(voice disguised, flat)

We have your son. He's fine — for now. You get him back when you pay.

FATHER grips the phone, knuckles white. Behind him, we see the son's empty shoes by the door.

FATHER

(shaken)

Don't hurt him. Whatever you want — just don't hurt him. I'll pay.

A beat of silence on the line. K1 exhales, like he's surprised it worked.

K1

Good. You'll get instructions. Don't call the police — or he doesn't come home.

5. INT. FATHER'S HOUSE - CONTINUOUS

FATHER lowers the phone, breathing hard. Fear curdles into something harder — rage, focus.

He pulls up a number-tracking app, keys in the caller's digits. A location pin drops onto a map: an industrial lot on the edge of town.

FATHER

(to himself)

Got you.

He grabs his car keys off the hook, checks nothing else, and is out the door before the screen even dims.

6. EXT. SAFEHOUSE – DAY

FATHER's car skids to a stop outside the shed. He's out before it fully stops, scanning the lot.

K1 steps around the corner of the building — and freezes. FATHER doesn't hesitate. He closes the distance in three strides and drives a fist into K1's jaw. K1 hits the dirt.

FATHER

(low, dangerous)

Where is he.

K1 scrambles back, hands raised, too stunned to answer fast enough. FATHER hauls him up by the collar.

7. EXT./INT. SAFEHOUSE – CONTINUOUS

Dragging K1 by the collar, FATHER shoves through the door. K2 is inside, and bolts for a side exit — doesn't make it two steps before FATHER is on him.

FATHER

(shouting)

My son! Where is my son!

K2 throws his hands up, but FATHER isn't listening anymore. A short, brutal exchange — K2 goes down hard beside K1, both of them beaten and cornered.

8. INT. SAFEHOUSE – CONTINUOUS

FATHER pushes deeper into the shed and finds SON curled against the far wall, awake now, frightened but unhurt.

SON

(voice cracking)

Dad?

FATHER drops to his knees and pulls SON into his arms, checking him over, holding on like he won't let go again.

FATHER

(quiet, fierce)

I've got you. I've got you, I'm here.

9. EXT./INT. SAFEHOUSE – CONTINUOUS

FATHER guides SON toward the door — and K3 blocks it, the last of the three, bigger and ready to fight where the others weren't.

FATHER pushes SON behind him.

FATHER

Get outside. Now.

SON scrambles past. K3 lunges. What follows is fast and ugly — no clean shots, both men taking hits, trading the door between them. FATHER fights like a man with nothing left to lose. K3 fights like a man who knows he's already lost.

A final exchange. K3 goes down and stays down.

FATHER stands over him, chest heaving, then turns without a word and walks out to where SON is waiting.

FADE OUT.